CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS TRAINING

Inside the Mind of a Hacker

Teaching teams to recognise attacks — by briefly thinking like the attacker, then defending against them.

ManpowerGroup Switzerland · WI-Projekt HS26 · Team Michele, Daniele & Lara

THE PROBLEM

Technology isn’t the weak point — people are the target

≈ 60%

of data breaches involve the human factor, not a technical flaw.

Daily

recruiters open files and messages from senders they don’t know.

1 inbox

is a door to candidates, clients and internal data alike.

Figures from project research and public breach reports.

OUR PRINCIPLE

“You learn the mechanism, not the instructions.”

Learners step into the attacker’s perspective to **see through** an attack — then practise the defence. No real tools, templates or usable attack guides are ever taught.

HOW IT WORKS

A guided path from awareness to action

1 · Pre-survey

A baseline with a confidence rating per question — required before the modules open.

2 · Modules

Per weakness: expert video → hacker mission → reveal. Earns a key, a badge and points.

3 · Company gate

One key per module; together they open the gate — then the roles flip.

4 · Defense level

Now the staff: spot attacks in an inbox, build a streak, report them.

5 · Post-survey

The same situations, rethought — this measures what changed.

6 · Evaluation

Personal result, team leaderboard, and a CSV export for the facilitator.

INSIDE A MODULE

Each module has three beats

🎬

Expert video

A specialist explains the weakness in depth — why it works and how to spot it.

→

🕵️

Hacker mission

The learner assesses what makes the attack dangerous — and sees the giveaway at once.

→

💡

Reveal

“What would have stopped this?” — the protective action, tied to the weakness.

🔑 **Key** collected 🎯 **Badge** unlocked ⭐ **Points** earned (weighted by difficulty)

THE FIVE WEAKNESSES

Five attacks every recruiter meets

#	Weakness	What the attacker is after
1	**Phishing & account takeover**	Mailbox or portal login — and the data behind it
2	**Malware in applications**	Remote access to the HR computer and candidate database
3	**CEO fraud**	An urgent data release or payment, before anyone asks
4	**Fake candidates & deepfakes**	Access to client systems through a forged identity
5	**Ransomware & data exfiltration**	The entire data set, plus a ransom — the full attack chain

GAMIFICATION

Recognition, turned into a game

🔑

Keys & company gate

One key per module; all keys together open the gate.

⭐

Points & difficulty

Harder weaknesses are worth more; hints cost points.

🎯

Themed badges

A badge per weakness mastered — a set to complete.

🔥

Defense streaks

A run of correct calls earns a bonus; a

🏆

Team leaderboard

Played in pairs; only the top three teams are

Why it works

Engaging, repeatable each season, and measurable.

THE DEFENSE LEVEL

Then the roles flip — now you guard the gate

An inbox mixes real attacks from the modules with harmless, genuine messages. Not every unusual message is an attack — the skill is telling them apart.

Process | Verify (2nd channel) | Report | Reject

The one habit: Pause → check the context → verify through a known, independent channel → report.

MEASURING LEARNING

We measure the change, not just completion

Before & after

Parallel surveys of equal difficulty, with no visible answers — a clean before/after comparison.

Confidence too

Each answer carries a self-rating, so we see not only what people know, but how sure they are.

CSV export

The facilitator exports all responses anonymised — ready to analyse across a group.

WHAT IT’S BASED ON

Grounded in real cases and how people learn

Real cases

- ManpowerGroup franchise, Lansing 2025 — ~145,000 people affected
- NCSC Switzerland: 970 CEO-fraud reports in 2025 (484 in 2023)

Learning science

- Perspective-taking makes the lesson stick
- Active recall over passive watching
- Before/after measurement of the effect

Safety guardrail

- Recognition over instruction
- No usable attack tooling or templates
- Fictional company and data throughout

Figures: public reports & NCSC Switzerland — verify before external use.

TEST PHASE & ACCESS

Live now, ready to test

In the test phase

- Modules 1 (Phishing) and 3 (CEO fraud) unlocked
- Runs as a web app — no install, any browser
- In English, in ManpowerGroup colours

Next steps

- Build modules 2, 4 and 5
- Record the remaining expert videos
- Run the pilot and evaluate the CSV data

Open the live prototype: **larabng.github.io/securityawareness**

THE ONE HABIT

Pause. Check the context. Verify independently. Report.

Everything in the training builds toward this one reflex — the habit that stops most attacks before they start.

Thank you — ManpowerGroup Switzerland · WI-Projekt HS26 · Michele, Daniele & Lara